

Furman University Society of Physics Students Constitution

CONSTITUTION SOCIETY OF PHYSICS STUDENTS INCLUDING SIGMA PI SIGMA, THE PHYSICS HONOR SOCIETY

ARTICLE I. NAME The name of this organization shall be “Society of Physics Students” with an honor society component named “Sigma Pi Sigma.”

ARTICLE II. OBJECTIVES The objectives of the Society of Physics Students shall be to: - encourage and assist students interested in physics and astronomy to develop the knowledge, competence, enthusiasm, and social responsibility that are essential to the advancement of physics and astronomy; - stimulate interest in advance study and research in physics; - develop collegiality among physics students and faculty members; - promote public interest in physics; - provide liaison between students and the member societies of the American Institute of Physics; and - recognize high scholarship and potential achievement in physics among outstanding students by means of Sigma Pi Sigma membership.

ARTICLE III. OFFICERS

Section 1. Elective Officers

Clause 1. The elective officers of the Society shall be the President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, and 2 Astronomy Chairs. Elective officers may not serve more than two consecutive full terms on the executive committee in the same office.

Clause 2. The President and the remainder of the committee shall be elected annually by the Furman University SPS Chapter members from a slate of at least two candidates. Elections for the President of the committee shall be held annually in April, i.e at the end of the second academic semester. The uncompleted term of a President who vacates the position between annual elections shall be filled as determined by majority vote of the Executive Committee until the next annual election when the remaining portion of the uncompleted term shall be filled through the normal election procedure. The duties of the President shall include serving on the Executive Committee as its chairperson and presiding over meetings of the executive committee.

Clause 3. For a member of the Furman University Chapter of SPS to be a voting member with regard to electing the executive committee, said member would have had to be present at no less than two meetings per semester.

Clause 4. All officers must be a declared Physics or Applied Physics Major.

Clause 5. The term of office shall be from April to March of a given year.

Clause 6. Election of officers shall be held annually.

At least two weeks' notice shall be given before the election meeting. Nominations shall be initiated from the floor and elections done by a ballot. The person receiving the majority vote will be elected.

Clause 7. Any officer may be removed from membership by a two-thirds vote of the Executive. Any officer removed may appeal to the general membership. Said officer shall be considered reinstated with two-thirds approval of the members.

Clause 8. Any vacancy which may occur in an office shall be filled by appointment by the president pending ratification at the next group business meeting.

Article IV

Section A: The President

1. The president shall be the chief executive officer
2. The president shall appoint all committee chairpersons
3. The president, with approval of the executive board, directs the budget
4. Vacancies in offices will be filled by appointment of the President with approval of the general membership.

Section B: The Vice President

1. The vice president shall be the parliamentarian for the organization.
2. The vice president shall assume the duties of the president in the absence of the president.
3. The vice president will keep and have available current copies of the constitution.
4. The vice president will be responsible for scheduling programs.

Section C: The Secretary

1. The secretary shall be responsible for keeping the minutes of all meetings and the meetings of the executive board.
2. The secretary will provide a copy of the minutes for each officer and keep a master file.
3. The secretary shall maintain a complete and accurate account of attendance and membership status.

Section D: Treasurer

1. The treasurer shall keep a current record of all financial transactions.
2. The treasurer shall develop quarterly reports containing a list of all receipts and disbursements and distribute them among the membership.
3. The treasurer will be responsible for checking the accuracy of all bills and invoices and paying them correctly and on time.
4. The treasurer will perform other duties as directed by the president.

Section E:

Astronomy Chair

1. Responsible for organizing all astronomy related events
2. Lead Astronomy meetings and planetarium shows

Section F: Advisor

1. The advisor shall be a physics faculty or staff member and assist the group in their execution of roles and responsibilities. They must be approved by the head of the physics department
2. The advisor shall provide feedback to the organization regarding its operation and functioning.
3. The advisor shall serve as a resource, and provide liaison among the Chapter, the department responsible for physics instructions, and the national office
4. The advisor should provide advice upon request, and also should share knowledge, expertise, and experience with the group.
5. The advisor will be a nonvoting member of the organization.

Article V

Section A: The times for regularly scheduled meetings shall be: Described by the acting President, after consultation with the Executive.

Section B: At least 3 days' notice shall be given for each regular business meeting.

Section C: Special or emergency meetings may be called with less than 1 days' notice by the Executive.

Section D: The meetings shall include a quorum, order of business, and disposition of the minutes.

A quorum for regular meetings is 25% of the membership, and for voting meetings is majority (greater than 50%) of the membership